

A GUIDE FROM MATTHEW 28:20

How to Obey God's Word

Scripture was never meant to only be studied — it was written to be lived. A short guide to turning reading into obedience.

“Teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you.”

MATTHEW 28:20

GREAT COMMISSION MINISTRIES · A GUIDE FOR DISCIPLES

1. Read It Like It's True

Obedience starts before you close the Bible — it starts with how you read it. Approach Scripture expecting it to actually apply to your Tuesday afternoon, not just to ancient history. Ask, “What does this ask of me?” as often as you ask “What does this mean?”

2. Don't Wait to Feel Ready

Obedience rarely arrives with a wave of motivation. Most obedience is a decision made before the feeling shows up. If you wait until obeying feels easy or natural, you may wait a lifetime. Start with the next small act of obedience in front of you, whether or not it feels significant.

3. Obey the Parts You Understand

You don't need to have every theological question answered to start obeying. Many people delay obedience by hiding behind confusion over difficult passages, while ignoring the plain instructions they already understand clearly — forgive, tell the truth, be generous, guard your eyes, love your neighbor. Start there.

4. Build in Accountability

It is far easier to quietly ignore Scripture than to quietly ignore a friend who is asking how it's going. Tell one or two people what you sense God is asking of you, and give them permission to ask about it later.

- Choose a specific instruction from Scripture, not a vague resolution.
- Name a person who will ask you about it in the next two weeks.
- Expect to fail sometimes — obedience is a direction, not instant perfection.
- When you fall short, return to it rather than abandoning it.

5. Remember Why

Obedience is not a transaction to earn God's love — it is the natural response of someone who already has it. We obey because we trust that God's instructions, even the hard ones, are for our good and His glory, not because obedience buys us anything.

A Verse to Anchor This

“If you love me, you will keep my commandments.” — John 14:15